



IN THE WAKE · [CRUISINGINTHEWAKE.COM](https://cruisinginthewake.com)

4-Night Bahamas Quick Escape — Nassau & Great Stirrup Cay

Norwegian Getaway · 4 Nights from Miami

August 24 – 28, 2026

A Voyage Pack from **In the Wake**

Welcome

Made for the cruiser who has already booked this specific sailing and wants one trusted read on the trip — the ship, the two Bahamian stops, the late-August weather math, and the compressed rhythm of a four-night hop — in one place.

This pack exists to make one specific cruise easier: the **Norwegian Getaway**, sailing 4 nights round-trip from **Miami, August 24 – 28, 2026**, calling at **Nassau** and **Great Stirrup Cay** (NCL's private island). It's a short sailing with one sea day, which changes how you plan it — more on that in **Section 9**.

Two things worth knowing before anything else

First: the timing. If you're reading this on the day it was written — Friday, August 21 — you sail **Monday**. NCL requires online check-in to be **completed at least 3 days before sailing**, which makes it a today item, not a weekend item. **Section 3** is a compressed countdown built for exactly this window.

Second: the waterpark. NCL has spent two years rebuilding Great Stirrup Cay, and the marquee piece — the **Great Tides Waterpark** — has its grand opening **September 4, 2026**. Your visit is **August 27 — eight days before it opens**. You will likely see it; you will not swim in it. The island you *do* get is genuinely good — a free 1.4-acre lagoon pool, three beaches, the barbecue, and (most likely) a brand-new pier instead of tender boats — and **Day 4 in Section 2** plans that honestly rather than selling you a park that isn't open yet.

A note on what's first-hand here and what isn't

This pack is built from primary-source research, not from having walked this exact deck plan: NCL's own published pages and FAQ for the ship, fares, and policies; PortMiami's port authority pages; the Nassau Cruise Port's official site; NCL's newsroom for the Great Stirrup Cay opening dates; the U.S. Embassy in Nassau for the advisory and consular contacts; and NOAA for the weather normals. Where sources

disagree — and on taxi tolls and beach-chair prices in Nassau they cheerfully do — the pack says so and gives you the range. If a number couldn't be sourced, it isn't asserted here.

It is calm by design. There is no urgency except the check-in deadline, no upsell, no countdown timer. The site that produced this pack is independent — no cruise-line affiliations, no shore-excursion commissions, no display ads. (See our **affiliate disclosure**.)

A note on the season. Late August sits on the climb toward the Atlantic hurricane season's September 10 peak. Most late-August sailings run warm and uneventful; some get rerouted. **Section 7** covers what that actually means for you, including the named-storm wrinkle in travel insurance bought this late.

Includes an offline-capable Emergency Contacts section — a fillable family handoff card and the numbers tailored to this itinerary. Print **Section 6** for whoever is holding down the fort at home.

At a Glance

Ship	Norwegian Getaway (Breakaway class)
Cruise line	Norwegian Cruise Line (NCL)
Class	Breakaway class — sister to Norwegian Breakaway (2013)
Specifications	145,655 GT · 1,068 ft / 326 m · 3,903 guests (double occupancy) · 2,008 staterooms (incl. 59 Studios) · 1,646 crew
Year built	2014 (Meyer Werft, Papenburg, Germany) · refurbished 2019 and 2024 · IMO 9606924
Godmothers	The Miami Dolphins Cheerleaders — fitting, for Miami's own ship

Distinctive	The LEBO mermaid hull art · The Waterfront quarter-mile oceanfront promenade · a ropes course NCL bills as the largest at sea
Departure port	PortMiami — NCL's Terminal B ("the Pearl of Miami"); confirm your terminal in your eDocs
Itinerary	4 nights / 5 days · Miami → sea day → Nassau → Great Stirrup Cay → Miami
Ship's registry	Nassau, Bahamas
Dress code	NCL smart-casual — no formal nights (one optional "Norwegian's Night Out")
Currency aboard	US Dollar
Documents	Closed-loop cruise: US citizens may sail on government photo ID + original/copy birth certificate — but a passport is the strong recommendation (Section 3)

The itinerary

1. **Miami, Florida** — embark Mon Aug 24 · ship departs 4:00 PM (aboard no later than 3:00 PM — hard cutoff)
2. **Cruising at sea** — Tue Aug 25
3. **Nassau, Bahamas** — Wed Aug 26 · 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM
4. **Great Stirrup Cay (NCL private island), Bahamas** — Thu Aug 27 · 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM
5. **Miami, Florida** — arrive Fri Aug 28 · 7:00 AM

Verify times in the Norwegian Cruise Line app — itineraries are subject to change, and in hurricane season they occasionally do. Track the ship's real position from the **Ship Tracker**.

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Section 1 — Your Ship: Norwegian Getaway

Miami's own ship

Norwegian Getaway was built *for* Miami and it shows. Delivered by Meyer Werft in January 2014 as the second Breakaway-class ship (sister: Norwegian Breakaway, 2013), she was christened in Miami on **February 7, 2014**, with the **Miami Dolphins Cheerleaders** as godmothers, and her hull wears Miami artist **David “LEBO” Le Batard’s** mural: a mermaid holding the sun, skimming the water with three pelicans alongside. LEBO said the mermaid stands for humanity’s connection to the sea and the pelicans for safe passage. It’s the best pier photo you’ll take all week.

At 145,655 gross tons and 1,068 feet, she carries 3,903 guests at double occupancy with 1,646 crew — big, but a size class below the newest megaships, which on a four-night hop works in your favor: less ship to learn in less time.

She was refreshed in a two-week June 2019 dry dock at Brest, France (the Norwegian Edge program) — that’s when she gained the full-service Starbucks, **Syd Norman’s Pour House** (a small live-rock room with a big following), the steampunk-styled **Illusionarium** dinner theater, an expanded, doubled-in-size **Vibe Beach Club**, and new soft goods through the staterooms. NCL lists a further refurbishment in 2024; the line hasn’t published a detailed scope for it, so treat 2024 as “freshened,” not “transformed.”

The spaces worth knowing

- **The Waterfront** — the quarter-mile open-air promenade wrapping Deck 8, lined with restaurant and bar terraces. Outdoor dinner at sea level(ish) is the Breakaway class’s signature move. Sunset here on your Nassau evening, as the ship pulls out at 5, is the trip’s best free hour.
- **678 Ocean Place** — the three-deck atrium hub (Decks 6–8) where the restaurants, bars, casino, and box office cluster. Learn it on Day 1 and you’ve learned the ship.
- **The ropes course** — 40+ elements, five zip tracks, and The Plank. NCL bills it as the largest ropes course at sea. Free, and quietest right at opening.
- **The Aqua Park** — five multi-story waterslides, including **Free Fall** — a drop slide NCL bills as the fastest at sea — and the twin racing **Whip** slides, plus a separate pirate-themed kids’ aqua park.
- **Vibe Beach Club** — the adults-only enclave (day/week passes at Guest Services, capacity-limited; buy Day 1 or go without). The quietest sunbeds on the ship.
- **Mandara Spa** (Deck 15) — thermal suite passes are sold for the cruise; on a 4-night sailing the math is kinder than usual.
- **The Studio complex** — 59 solo staterooms with a private keycard lounge. Why this matters is **Section 10**.
- **Casinos At Sea** (Deck 7), **Splash Academy** (3–12), **Entourage** (teens), **Guppies** (littles) — all present and standard-NCL.

Dining — what’s actually on this ship in 2026

Ship dining lineups drift, so this list is from NCL's current Getaway pages, not from memory or an old review:

Included in your fare: The Manhattan Room (the supper-club main dining room on Deck 7 — renamed from the Tropicana Room), **Taste** and **Savor** (the Deck 6 MDR twins), **Garden Café** (the Deck 15 buffet), **O'Sheehan's Neighborhood Bar & Grill** (Deck 7 — this ship kept O'Sheehan's rather than the newer "Local" branding), **American Diner** (Deck 16), and **Shanghai's Noodle Bar** (Deck 7).

Specialty (extra cost, book Day 1): Cagney's Steakhouse, Le Bistro (French), **Teppanyaki, La Cucina** (Italian), **Moderno Churrascaria, Ocean Blue** (seafood), **The Raw Bar**, and **Wasabi** (sushi). Note: Getaway does **not** have Food Republic — that's other NCL ships.

The in-betweens: Starbucks, Dolce Gelato, The Bake Shop, and the **Sugarcane Mojito Bar** (Deck 8 — order the classic, sit on the Waterfront side).

Entertainment currently aboard

The 2026 lineup in the Getaway Theater runs **Bring Back the 90s, The Broadway Cabaret: Rock Edition**, and NCL's game-show staples (**Deal or No Deal, Wheel of Fortune**). Around the ship: **Howl at the Moon** dueling pianos, **Headliners Comedy Club, Famous Riffz, Syd Norman's Pour House** (small room, fills fast — arrive 30 minutes early), and the **Illusionarium** magic dinner show. On a four-night sailing, shows repeat little — check the app on embarkation afternoon and book then, not later.

Section 2 — Day by Day

Day 1 — Monday, August 24 · Miami · departs 4:00 PM

- **The hard numbers:** online check-in gave you an arrival window; don't show up more than an hour before it. NCL *encourages* being aboard 2 hours before sailing; the **hard cutoff is 1 hour before** — at the dock and checked in by **3:00 PM** or you are watching your cruise leave. Aim for late morning.

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- **Terminal:** NCL sails from **Terminal B**, the mirrored “Pearl of Miami” — your eDocs confirm the assignment (short sailings occasionally shuffle terminals; trust the eDocs, not the internet).
 - First hour aboard: drop carry-ons, **book everything** — specialty dinner, Illusionarium, Vibe pass if you want one, spa pass. On a 4-night sailing the inventory is gone by dinner (**Section 9**).
 - Muster: complete the safety check-in as soon as you board — follow the instructions in the app and at your assigned station; it’s a ten-minute chore. Do it before the bars open. It matters.
 - Sailaway at 4: the Waterfront rail or the top deck, LEBO’s mermaid below you, the Miami skyline sliding past. This is the postcard.

Day 2 — Tuesday, August 25 · At sea

Your only sea day, so it carries everything: the ropes course and Free Fall before the lines build (first hour after opening), a long lunch, the thermal suite if you bought in, and a proper look at the daily program for the two port days. August sea days in the Bahamas corridor are hot and bright — hydrate, shade at midday, and remember the pools are salt-adjacent chaos by 11 AM; Vibe or the Waterfront loungers are the calmer bet.

Evening: this is the natural specialty-dinner night. If you booked nothing, the Manhattan Room’s supper-club room does the occasion better than you’d expect for included dining.

Day 3 — Wednesday, August 26 · Nassau · 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM

Know the day you’re walking into: five ships are scheduled alongside you — Wonder of the Seas, Freedom of the Seas, Disney Destiny, and Carnival Glory. That’s a very full Bay Street by mid-morning. The play is to go out **early** (gangway at 8) or go **contrarian** (leave at 10:30 when the first wave is already at the beaches).

The port itself is genuinely pleasant post-renovation — the 2023 rebuild left a clean modern terminal with free Wi-Fi, 60+ shops, a food hall, and the Junkanoo museum. Ships dock; no tenders; you walk off.

The free-to-cheap day (walkable): - **Queen's Staircase** — 66 steps that enslaved workers hewed from solid limestone in 1793–94, later named for Queen Victoria; free; a 10–15 minute walk. Worth standing at the bottom of quietly for a moment. Locals may offer narration and expect a tip. - **Fort Fincastle** — at the top of the Staircase; bring a few dollars cash (published admission figures conflict; it's cheap either way). - **Parliament Square** — the pink colonial government buildings; free; 5–8 minutes from the pier. - **John Watling's Distillery** — free entry, free tour, complimentary tasting, in a 1789 estate; about a 15-minute uphill walk. - **Straw Market** — Bay Street institution; free to wander; haggling is the sport. - **Junkanoo Beach** — the cruiser's beach, 10 minutes' walk west; free sand, chairs about \$10 and umbrellas about \$20 from the vendors. On a five-ship day it *will* be busy.

The mid-tier day: Cable Beach by taxi (\$18–25 per cab each way, zone-fared) — longer, calmer sand. Or the water taxi to Paradise Island (\$4–6 per person, prices quoted vary) for **Cabbage Beach** — public and free, chair vendors negotiable.

The big-ticket day: **Atlantis Aquaventure** day passes (about \$195 adult and up, dynamic pricing, advance purchase — quantities are capped daily and do sell out) or **Baha Bay** at Baha Mar (\$160 adult all-in, passes capped daily and sold online ahead of your visit — sort it before you sail; ship Wi-Fi is a bad place to race a sellout). Taxi to Atlantis \$15–20 plus a \$1–2 bridge toll; no jitney serves Paradise Island.

Straight talk on safety: The Bahamas carries a **U.S. State Department Level 2 advisory** (“Exercise Increased Caution,” renewed July 28, 2026). For a cruise visitor the practical version is: stay on the main tourist streets and beaches, don't wander the “Over the Hill” neighborhood south of Shirley Street, don't rent jet skis from independent beach operators (U.S. government personnel are barred from doing so), don't swim alone, and treat sunset as the natural end of your wandering. Tens of thousands of cruisers do Nassau daily without incident; the ones who have stories usually broke one of those rules. Jitney buses (\$1.25) are fine by day. Currency: Bahamian dollars run 1:1 with USD and both are accepted everywhere; tip about 15%, and check the bill first — many places add it.

Back aboard by **4:00 PM** (ship's time, one hour before departure). The Waterfront rail at 5 as Nassau slides away is the day's dessert.

Day 4 — Thursday, August 27 · Great Stirrup Cay · 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM

NCL's 270-acre private island in the Berry Islands — the line's beach day has run here since 1977, and NCL has spent 2025–26 rebuilding the island wholesale. Here's the honest state of it for *your* date:

- **The pier:** a brand-new two-berth pier welcomed its first ship in December 2025, closed in April 2026 for its second-berth expansion, and reports from early August 2026 say docking has resumed. Expect to **walk off**; if weather or operations intervene, the fallback is the classic tender run (follow the gangway announcement, not assumptions — and if tendering, go early).
- **The waterpark: closed.** Great Tides opens **September 4** — final testing and theming will be visibly underway behind its fences. Don't budget a dollar or a minute for it.
- **What's open and free:** the **Great Life Lagoon** — a 1.4-acre zero-entry pool NCL describes as bigger than two Olympic pools combined, with two swim-up bars; **three white-sand beaches** with complimentary loungers and umbrellas (first-come — the good shade goes by 10); the **Splash Harbor** kids' splash pad; the island tram from the new Welcome Plaza; and the all-you-can-eat spread at **Jumbey Beach Grill** plus **Abaco Taco** and the roving hot-dog carts. The island barbecue-and-beach day that made this stop beloved is fully intact.
- **Worth knowing:** if you have an NCL beverage package, it **works on the island** (NCL reversed a planned exclusion in March 2026). Cocktails without a package run about \$15.
- **Paid options, if you want structure:** the **Seahawk Zipline** (\$99 — a 2,975-foot course whose main line runs 1,400+ feet over the water), snorkel gear rental (~\$35, with an underwater sculpture garden off the beach), **Vibe Shore Club** (the adults-only beach club, day passes reported around \$79–90; premium cabana \$749), **Silver Cove** villas (private enclave with Mandara Spa, from roughly \$660), and lagoon cabanas (roughly \$229 and up). Every price here varies by sailing — the app's excursion tab has yours.
- **Practicalities:** cell signal is spotty-to-absent and there's no guest Wi-Fi ashore — tell anyone expecting to hear from you that Thursday is a quiet day (**Section 6**). No ATMs; bring a little cash for tips. Water shoes help on the rocky patches. The 1863 lighthouse — the island's oldest structure — is a pleasant walk or tram hop if you want one non-beach thing.

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- All-aboard is one hour before the 5:00 PM departure; if tenders are running, plan your beach exit around 3:30.

Day 5 — Friday, August 28 · Miami · arrives 7:00 AM

- Staterooms must be vacated by **8:00 AM**.
 - **Easy Walk Off** (you carry everything) starts once the ship clears — typically 7:30–8:00 — and is the right call for a 4-night bag. Checked bags go out the night before with color tags and meet you in the terminal.
 - **Flights:** from **MIA**, book nothing before about **noon**. The published planning rule is roughly five hours after docking; NCL's own air program won't book you before 9 AM, and that's their floor, not a recommendation. An 8-mile ride does not make MIA a fast airport.
 - If you drove: Garage B, elevator, done. If you're rideshare-ing, the pickup lot queue at PortMiami on a Friday morning moves faster before 9 than after.
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Section 3 — The Three-Day Countdown

Built for the actual window between this pack's writing and the sailing.

Today (Friday) — the non-negotiables

1. **Complete NCL online check-in.** It must be done **at least 3 days before sailing** — for an Aug 24 departure that deadline is now. [ncl.com](https://www.ncl.com) or the Norwegian Cruise Line app; you'll pick your terminal arrival time and get your eDocs.
2. **Documents check.** This is a closed-loop cruise (Miami out, Miami back), so a U.S. citizen may sail with a government photo ID plus an original or copy of a birth certificate (per CBP's Western Hemisphere rules; kids 16-and-under need only the citizenship proof). **Take the passport anyway if you have one** — it's the difference between an inconvenience and a crisis if you miss the ship in Nassau or fly home unexpectedly.

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3. **Look at the tropics once.** nhc.noaa.gov, two minutes. Not to worry — to know. **Section 7** explains what a system in the map actually means for a Bahamas hop.
 4. **Travel insurance, eyes open:** you can still buy a policy up to the day before departure, but time-sensitive extras (cancel-for-any-reason, pre-existing-condition waivers) are off the table this late, and **once a storm has a name, it isn't a covered reason** on a standard policy. Buy for the medical/evacuation coverage, which is the part that matters most anyway.

Saturday — the sensible

1. Book the big Nassau item if you want one — **Baha Bay's daily-capped passes and Atlantis day passes are both advance-purchase and both sell out**; check Wednesday's availability online now rather than gambling on it from the ship.
2. Print **Section 6**, fill in the blanks, hand it to your at-home person.
3. Download the **Norwegian Cruise Line app** and log in — daily programs, bookings, and your account live there; it's free to use over ship Wi-Fi without buying minutes.
4. Cash: a modest stack of small bills — Nassau taxis/chair vendors and island tips run on it. No ATMs on the cay.

Sunday — the calm

1. Pack (**Section 4**). Four nights packs light.
 2. Confirm Monday's ride and timing: at the terminal by late morning, aboard well before 3:00 PM.
 3. Charge everything; sleep.
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Section 4 — Packing List

The late-August Bahamas rule is: **less clothing, more sun management.**

- **Swim:** two suits (one's always wet), rash guard or swim shirt (the sun is the day's main event), **water shoes** (Great Stirrup Cay's rocky patches; Nassau's mixed sand).
 - **Sun: reef-safe sunscreen** (lots — you will use more than you think), hat with a real brim, sunglasses.
 - **Rain:** a packable light shell or cheap poncho. August afternoons produce brief, theatrical downpours (~19 rain days is the month's normal); they pass in twenty minutes.
 - **Clothes:** shorts/tees/sundresses; one smart-casual outfit if a specialty dinner or Norwegian's Night Out is in your plans (no formal nights on NCL, ever); light layer for the dining rooms' air conditioning.
 - **Practical:** a small day bag for ports, refillable water bottle, a dry bag or zip-lock for phone-at-the-beach, motion-sickness tablets (**Section 7**), any medications in original containers **in your carry-on**, and the printed handoff card for home.
 - **Documents:** passport (or ID + birth certificate — see **Section 3**), eDocs, a photo of each on your phone.
 - **Skip:** hair dryer (aboard), beach towels (the ship provides, take them ashore), anything formal, boxed wine (prohibited; sealed 750 ml bottles are allowed at \$15 corkage each, waived if you hold a beverage package).
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Section 5 — Budget Breakdown

Run your own numbers with the **budget calculator**, the **drink calculator**, and the **tipping calculator** — but here's the honest shape of a 4-night Getaway hop, per person, beyond the fare:

Item	Amount	Notes
Daily service charge	\$80 (\$20 × 4 nights)	\$25/day in Haven & Suites → \$100. Applies from age 3. Adjustable at Guest Services if something went genuinely wrong.
Beverage gratuity	20%	Auto-added to every bar, spa, and specialty-dining purchase — including “free” package drinks’ one-time gratuity if your fare bundles Free at Sea (that gratuity is pre-paid before sailing, not on board).
Nassau — walkable day	\$0–40	Staircase free, fort a few dollars, Junkanoo Beach chair+umbrella ~\$30.
Nassau — resort day	\$160–250+	Baha Bay \$160 all-in; Atlantis ~\$195+ before VAT; plus \$16–24 round-trip taxi.
Great Stirrup Cay	\$0 baseline	Beaches, lagoon pool, BBQ, tram: included. Zipline \$99 · snorkel ~\$35 · Vibe ~\$79+ if you want them.
Specialty dinner	~\$40–80	Or one is included if your booking carries Free at Sea (2–4-night sailings include one meal).
Wi-Fi	\$0–plan cost	Free at Sea includes 150 Starlink minutes; the island has effectively none either way.
Cash to carry	~\$100–150 small bills	Taxis, vendors, tips ashore; no ATMs on the cay.

Item	Amount	Notes
Parking (if driving)	\$35/day, Garage B	A Mon–Fri sailing spans five calendar days — plan on ~\$175 and confirm at the garage. NCL added a Garage B pre-reservation system in April 2026; reserve before you drive.

If your booking includes Free at Sea (NCL’s current bundle): the premium open bar works on Great Stirrup Cay too, the \$50-per-port shore-excursion credit applies to things like the zipline, and the specialty meal covers your Cagney’s or Le Bistro night. Check your confirmation — it changes the whole discretionary column.

The one-time costs that ambush people: the 20% service charge on everything discretionary, and the corkage if you bring wine. That’s the whole trap list on this line.

Section 6 — Emergency Contacts

Print this page. Fill in the blanks. One copy in your bag, one on the fridge at home, a photo on your phone.

FAMILY HANDOFF – IN THE WAKE VOYAGE PACK

CRUISER: _____

CABIN: _____

SHIP: Norwegian Getaway

LINE: Norwegian Cruise Line

SAILING: August 24 – 28, 2026

FROM: PortMiami Terminal B,
1015 N. America Way, Miami, FLITINERARY: Miami → (sea day) →
Nassau, Bahamas (Wed Aug 26) →
Great Stirrup Cay, Bahamas (Thu Aug 27)
→ Miami (Fri Aug 28, 7:00 AM)AT-HOME CONTACT: _____

EMERGENCY (24/7) – US State Dept, Overseas

Citizens Services (locates the ship; works
through official channels, no cost):

+1 (888) 407-4747 (US/Canada)

+1 (202) 501-4444 (from abroad)

NCL – CONTACT A GUEST AT SEA (ship-to-shore
relay; card payment required):

+1 (833) 810-7963 (US/Canada)

+1 (321) 953-9006 (international)

NCL RESERVATIONS/SERVICE: +1 (866) 234-7350

NEAREST US ASSISTANCE BY PORT:

Miami, FL – US domestic; call 911

Nassau, BS – US Embassy Nassau,
235 Shirley Street:
+1 (242) 461-5025 (opt. 1
for US-citizen emergencies)
Local emergency: 919Great Stirrup Cay – NCL private island;
ship's medical & security

CRUISER MEDICAL:

Allergies: _____

Medications: _____

Conditions: _____

Insurance: _____ policy: _____

TRACK THE SHIP: </tools/ship-tracker.html>
or marinetraffic.com – search "Norwegian

Getaway" (IMO 9606924)

For the person at home: if you haven't heard anything

1. **Don't panic on silence.** Thursday (the private island) has effectively no cell signal, and ship Wi-Fi is an optional purchase. Silence means signal, not trouble, in almost every case.
 2. On a real emergency at home: call **NCL's contact-a-guest line** above with the ship name, sailing dates, and cabin if you have it — they relay to the ship.
 3. On a real emergency abroad: the **State Department OCS line** is the 24/7 front door; for anything in Nassau itself, the **Embassy** number above.
 4. The ship's position is public — the tracker links above always know where it is.
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Section 7 — Late-August Weather, Honestly

What August 24–28 usually looks like

- **Miami:** normals of 91°F days / 78°F nights, with about 9.6 inches of rain across the month — mostly as short afternoon storms (NOAA 1991–2020 normals).
- **Nassau:** effectively identical — 90/75, ~9.3 inches over ~19 rain days, humidity parked near 79%. Sea temperature around 84°F, which is bathwater.
- The daily pattern: brilliant morning, building clouds, a loud 20-minute downpour somewhere in the afternoon, a rinsed-clean evening. Plan beach mornings; hold indoor options loosely for 2–4 PM.

The hurricane-season paragraph, without drama

The Atlantic season runs June 1 – November 30 and its climatological peak is **September 10**; your dates sit on the mid-August ramp toward it. What that means, practically:

- **Most likely outcome by far:** hot, bright, occasionally soggy, entirely normal.
- **If a system develops:** cruise lines don't sail into storms — they sail around them. On a Bahamas hop the usual result is a swapped port, a substituted sea day, or (rarely) a schedule shift. Uncomfortable seas are possible on the margins; genuine danger is what the rerouting exists to prevent.
- **Your job is small:** glance at nhc.noaa.gov before you leave, keep the app's notifications on, and hold the itinerary loosely. The captain's decisions aren't a customer-service failure; they're the system working.
- **Insurance nuance (buying this late):** policies bought now still cover the big things — medical, evacuation, baggage — but a storm that already has a name when you buy is excluded as a cancellation reason. See **Section 3**.

Seasickness, briefly

The Miami–Bahamas corridor is a short, generally calm run, and Getaway is a large, stabilized ship. If you're prone: meclizine or dimenhydrinate from home (the ship sells them at a markup), start the night before, pick mid-ship if choosing a cabin were still possible, and know that the Great Life Lagoon does not move at all. Ginger works better than pride.

Section 8 — Practical Logistics

Getting to the ship

- **From MIA:** ~8 miles / 15–20 minutes. Uber/Lyft ~\$25–30; metered taxi ~\$35–40 (Miami retired the old airport-to-port flat rate); shared shuttles \$20–30 per person and slower.

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- **Driving:** navigate to **1761 N. Cruise Blvd, Miami, FL 33132** (NCL's stated navigation address; the port's mailing address is 1015 N. America Way). Park in **Garage B** — NCL's recommended garage, adjacent to its terminal — at **\$35/day**, credit card or cash (no debit). As of April 2026 NCL runs a **pre-reservation system** for Garage B; reserve online before you drive.
 - **Terminal B** — “the Pearl of Miami,” NCL's 190,000-sq-ft glass terminal. Your eDocs confirm the assignment; trust them over any website, including this one.

Aboard

- **Money:** the ship is cashless USD — everything bills to your keycard, backed by Visa/MC/Amex, or by a cash deposit (\$150 covers a sailing of this length) at Guest Services.
- **The app:** “Norwegian Cruise Line” in the app stores. Daily program, bookings, account, deck maps. Works on ship Wi-Fi without buying a Wi-Fi plan.
- **Time:** the ship stays on Eastern Time this whole itinerary, but always confirm “ship's time” announcements — all-aboard runs on it.
- **Laundry:** no self-service laundrettes on NCL — bag service only. On a 4-night trip, pack through it.

The Bahamas, administratively

- Closed-loop documents as covered in **Section 3**; bring the passport anyway.
 - Bahamian and US dollars interchange 1:1 everywhere; no exchange needed.
 - The Level 2 advisory practicalities are in the **Nassau day**.
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Section 9 — The Short-Cruise Rhythm

A four-night cruise is not a compressed seven-night cruise; it's a different animal, and it rewards different behavior.

Book everything in the first hour. On a week-long sailing you can browse; here, the one Illusionarium slot you'd like and the Cagney's table at 7 are gone by the first evening. Board, drop bags, open the app, spend ten decisive minutes.

One sea day means one shot. Ropes course, slides, thermal suite, long shameless nap — Tuesday is the only day at sea, and the ship knows it: it's also the most programmed day. Skim the daily program the night before and star three things, not eight.

Don't over-plan the ports. Two port days, both 8-to-5, both genuinely good on a lazy setting. The classic short-cruise mistake is treating Nassau like a checklist; the better version is one anchor activity plus wandering. The island day plans itself.

The evenings are the value. Short sailings skew social — more first-timers, more celebrators, fuller bars, better energy at Howl at the Moon and Syd Norman's. Lean in; the sleep-when-you're-home math is favorable on a Friday-morning return.

Disembark like a pro. Easy Walk Off with a 4-night bag is the single best logistics decision this trip offers: no night-before bag surrender, no terminal luggage hunt, off the ship inside the first hour.

Section 10 — Solo Cruising Considerations

Getaway is one of the better big ships to sail alone, for one structural reason: **the Studio complex** — 59 solo staterooms built and priced for one, sharing a private keycard-access **Studio Lounge** with coffee, snacks, and the easy sociability of a room where everyone came alone on purpose. Even if you're not *in* a Studio this trip, know the culture exists aboard: check the daily program for **solo traveler meet-ups**, usually early evening — on short sailings they're small and unforced, exactly right for finding a dinner companion or a Nassau walking partner without committing to a week of anyone.

Other solo-friendly furniture on this ship: the **Manhattan Room** happily seats singles and shared tables on request; **O'Sheehan's** bar seating is the easiest no-reservation dinner alone in cruising; the Waterfront's bar terraces let you be out among people without performing; and Vibe, if you get a pass, is where solo adults actually relax.

Ashore, the solo version of the safety paragraph: Nassau on a five-ship Wednesday is easy solo territory **on the main streets and beaches** — the Level 2 advisory specifics (no Over the Hill wandering, no independent jet-ski rentals, no swimming alone, daylight rules) matter a bit more when nobody's tracking your afternoon. Tell someone aboard or at home your port plan; the handoff card's at-home contact is for exactly this. On the cay, solo is effortless — it's a beach with a tram.

If this is your first solo sailing, **the solo cruising stories** on the site are worth a read on your sea day.

Section 11 — First Cruise Notes

If this is your first cruise, the five things that genuinely matter:

1. **Muster (safety check-in) is mandatory and first.** Do it immediately on boarding — scan at your station, watch the safety content in the app or cabin TV. Ten minutes. The crew cannot legally sail around you skipping it.
2. **Ship's time is the only time.** Announcements, all-aboard, excursion meets — all run on the ship's clock, which stays Eastern this trip. Your phone may lie to you in port; the app won't.
3. **All-aboard is one hour before departure, and it is not a suggestion.** In Nassau that's 4:00 PM. The ship genuinely leaves. (If you're ever on a *ship-sold* excursion running late, the ship waits for its own tours — one argument for booking the big stuff through NCL.)
4. **Budget the invisible 20%.** Every drink, spa treatment, and specialty meal adds a 20% service charge at the register, on top of the daily service charge. First-timers meet their folio on Day 2 with a small shock; now you won't.
5. **The daily program is the cruise.** Everything — hours, shows, meet-ups, sail-away times — lives in the app's daily listing. Five minutes with it each evening and you'll never feel lost aboard.

And the softer one: a short cruise is permission to do less. The ship will still be doing plenty.

Sources

The full research trail, with per-claim sources and dates, lives in this pack's fact-check sidecar. Soli Deo Gloria.